

Lab 1

Exploring Tools related to E-commerce & Digital Marketing

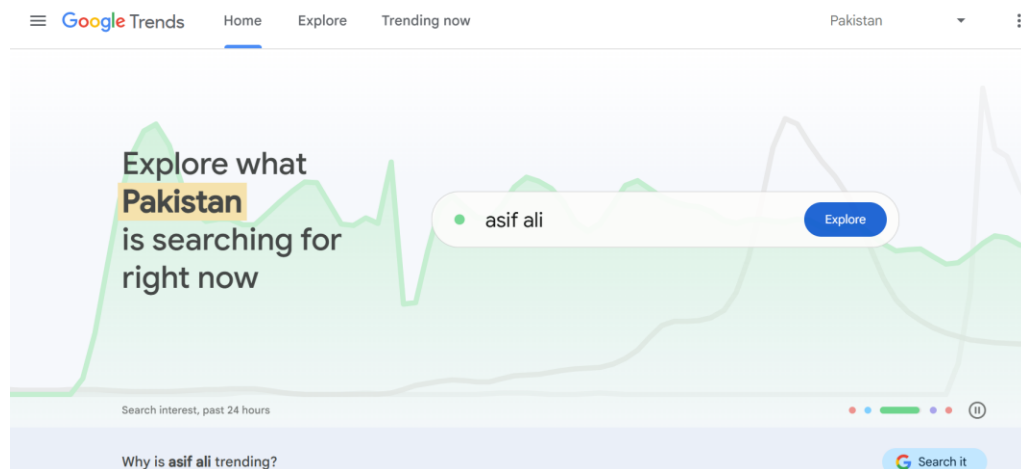
Introduction

In this lab, students will explore digital marketing tools through practical, hands-on activities. The goal is to provide exposure to industry-relevant platforms that help businesses build visibility, analyze markets, and improve online presence. The lab is divided into four parts: Google Trends, Competitor Analysis, Google Sites Portfolio, and Google Search Console.

Useful Concepts:

1. Google Trends (Pakistan Focus)

Google Trends is a free tool that shows how often particular search terms are entered into Google relative to the total search volume across different regions and time periods.



Purpose: Students will use Google Trends to identify trending topics in Pakistan, compare interest levels of products or services, and understand seasonal changes in consumer behavior.

Skills Developed: Keyword research, market demand analysis, and local digital marketing strategy planning.

2. Competitor Analysis

Competitor analysis helps students learn how to evaluate rival businesses in the online space. Even simple, free tools (such as Google search, SimilarWeb, or manual observation of social media and websites) can provide useful insights.



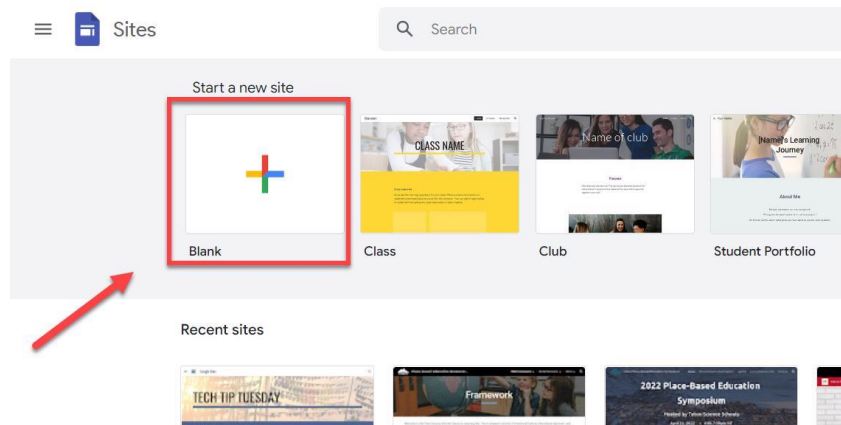
Purpose: Students will identify a competitor's keywords, website structure, content style, and social presence.

Skills Developed: Benchmarking, recognizing market gaps, and developing a more effective e-commerce or digital marketing strategy.

3. Online Portfolio using Google Sites

Google Sites is a free, easy-to-use platform that allows students to build their own personal portfolio websites without coding.

Purpose: Each student will create a starter online portfolio to showcase their skills, projects, and achievements. This is not only useful for academic purposes but also for professional branding in the digital marketplace.

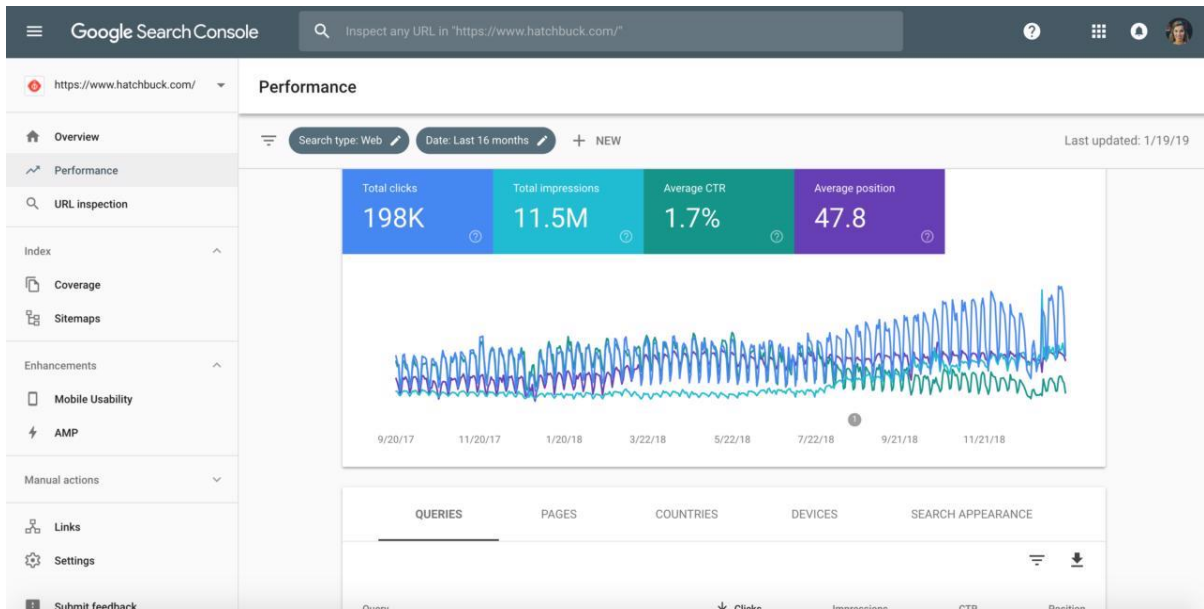


Skills Developed: Website creation, digital branding, and presenting personal or business information online in a structured manner.

4. Google Search Console (GSC)

Google Search Console is a web service by Google that helps website owners monitor, maintain, and troubleshoot their site's presence in Google Search results. After creating their portfolio site, students will link it to Google Search Console.

Purpose: By connecting their Google Sites portfolio to GSC, students will understand how websites are indexed, discover search performance data, and learn about issues like mobile usability and site visibility.



Skills Developed: SEO basics, performance monitoring, and technical site optimization.

Activity 1: Exploring Google Trends (Pakistan)

- Step 1: Go to <https://trends.google.com>
- Step 2: Select 'Pakistan' as your region.
- Step 3: Search for a product category (e.g., 'Air Conditioner').
- Step 4: Add a comparison keyword (e.g., 'Refrigerator').
- Step 5: Note peak months, rising queries, and regional interest.
- Step 6: Export or screenshot your findings.

Solved Example

- Query: AC vs Refrigerator
- AC peaks in May–June, Refrigerator is more steady.
 - Top Region: Karachi for AC, Punjab for Refrigerator.
 - Rising Query: 'Best inverter AC 2024'

Table Template

Keyword 1 vs Keyword 2	Peak Months	Top Region	Rising Query
AC vs Refrigerator	May–June vs Steady	Karachi vs Punjab	Best inverter AC 2024

Activity 2: Competitor Snapshot (Daraz vs Amazon)

Step 1: Open Daraz.pk and Amazon.com.

Step 2: Pick one product (e.g., 'Sneakers').

Step 3: Compare product details: Price, Reviews, Delivery options.

Step 4: Note differences in user experience.

Step 5: Record insights in a table.

Solved Example

Platform	Price (PKR)	Reviews	Delivery
Daraz vs Amazon Sneakers	Daraz: ~2,500 Amazon: ~5,000	Daraz: Few hundred Amazon: Thousands	Daraz: Local Amazon: International

Activity 3: Create a Mini Portfolio on Google Sites

(*Proper Portfolio in next week Lab).

Step 1: Go to <https://sites.google.com>

Step 2: Click '+ Blank Site'.

Step 3: Title it 'My Digital Marketing Portfolio'.

Step 4: Add your name, profile picture, and a short introduction.

Step 5: Create sections: About Me, Lab Work, Contact Info.

Step 6: Publish the site and copy the URL.

Sample Content (Improve the contents and expand)

About Me:

I am a student of E-commerce & Digital Marketing, learning how businesses use digital tools to reach customers.

Lab Work:

- Google Trends exploration
- Competitor analysis (Daraz vs Amazon)
- Contact Info: Email: student@example.com

Submission Checklist

- Screenshot(s) from Google Trends, Google Sites & Search Console.
- Completed competitor analysis table.
- Live link of Google Sites portfolio

Activity 4:

Lab Activity: Connecting Google Sites to Google Search Console

Objective:

Students will learn how to connect their Google Sites portfolio to Google Search Console (GSC), verify ownership, and explore key features (Performance, Indexing, Mobile Usability).

Requirements:

- Each student must have a Google Site (from the previous activity).
- A Google account.

Step by Step Activity

Step 1: Access Google Search Console

Go to <https://search.google.com/search-console> and sign in with the same Google account used to create the Google Site.

Step 2: Add Property

Click 'Add Property'. Select 'URL prefix'. Paste Google Site URL (example: <https://sites.google.com/view/username-portfolio>). Click Continue. For Google Sites, ownership is automatically verified since both use the same account.

Step 3: Explore Performance Report

Navigate to Performance → Search Results. Note: for new sites, there may be little or no data. The instructor can show data from the Demo Account. Record queries, clicks, impressions, CTR, and position (if available).

Step 4: Explore Index Coverage

Go to Pages → Indexing. Check if pages are indexed by Google. If not, use 'Request Indexing' for the portfolio homepage.

Step 5: Mobile Usability

Navigate to Mobile Usability. Check if the site is mobile-friendly. Note any warnings or errors (Google Sites are usually optimized).

Step 6: Reflection & Reporting

Each student writes a short note: Was their site indexed? Any mobile usability issues? What are the benefits of using GSC for e-commerce or portfolios?

Lab1 Report Submission Checklist

- Research on these topics and prepare a 1 page usage report on the topics: Google Trends, Portfolio & Search Console with regard to E-commerce.
- Screenshot(s) of your work from Google Trends, portfolio & Search console.
- Completed Google, Trends, Competitor Analysis Table.
- Live link of Google Sites portfolio.